



We will introduce the goods and services tax (GST) from April 1, 2010

- Introduce a moderate goods and services tax (GST), as the next decisive step after the successful introduction of the VAT. Once GST is implemented, all other central and state-level indirect taxes such as VAT, excise duty, service tax, entertainment tax, luxury tax, etc. will stand abolished and bring substantial relief to the aam admi
- GST will create a seamless national common market for our farmers, artisans and entrepreneurs and will boost employment. State finances, and more importantly the finances of panchayats and nagarpalikas, will be put on sound foundation



We will give a completely new look to urban governance

- Create a new model of urban administration with financially-viable self-government institutions as the pivot
- Undertake a massive programme of low-cost social housing and sanitation to make our urban areas more livable

We will offer a new deal to our youth to participate in governance

- Continue our commitment of empowering our youth, a process which was pioneered by Rajiv Gandhi who gave all 18 year-olds the right to vote and declared Swami Vivekananda's birthday on January 12th as National Youth Day
- Design and launch a voluntary national youth corps which would enable young men and women in the age group of 18-23 to serve for up to two years in constructive nation-building activities
- Make a beginning to induct youth into organs of government. To start with,

reserve a proportion of seats in panchayats and nagarpalikas for men and women below the age of 35 years

We will pursue judicial reforms to cut delays in courts

- Ensure the implementation of the the Gram Nyayalaya Act that was passed by Parliament last year
- Gram Nyayalayas at the headquarters of the intermediate panchayats and mobile courts in the rural areas will bring speedy, affordable and substantial justice to the aam admi

We will ensure energy security for our country

- Ensure that the country adds at least 12,000-15,000 mw of energy generation capacity every year through a mix of sources
- Ensure that rural electrification and reduction in distribution losses is given the highest priority
- Increase the share of nuclear power, both through domestic and foreign technology, which has now become possible by the civil nuclear agreements signed by our government

We will take further steps to preserve and promote our heritage

- Institute a statutory National Heritage Sites Commission. This will be an important instrument to strengthen the foundations of our pluralistic culture and inheritances

We will intensify the involvement of overseas Indians in development

- Ensure the continuation of the successful activities of the Ministry of Overseas Indian Affairs that was created by us in May 2004 to connect with and maximise the contributions of the overseas Indian community to our country's progress
- Establish four new universities with 50% of the seats reserved for PIO/ NRI students

